

Indian Customers Set The Pace

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Few people see Indian electronics buying behaviour at the resolution Zebha Khan does.

The Amazon India director argues the right question isn't what technology will do next – it's what Indian customers will demand of it. Her bet on the next 25 years: AI will get more powerful, but the real transformation will be access.

How has tech evolved over the past 25 years, and Digit's role?

If you compare how Indian customers shop for electronics today versus 25 years ago, the distance travelled is striking. The questions they ask are sharper. The comparisons they make are more nuanced. They know what they want and they also know when a product isn't delivering it. Tech has had to keep pace with that evolution.

Digit has been a meaningful part of this shift. Running products through over a hundred test parameters before forming a view, building test centres at a time when that rigour simply didn't exist in Indian tech media. It is this consistency that raised the bar for everyone.

Perhaps the less obvious legacy is that much of the talent that built India's technology journalism ecosystem came through Digit. That kind of institutional contribution may not show up

in numbers, but it distinctly shapes an entire industry.

How is tech going to transform our lives in the next 25 years?

The more interesting question is not what technology will do in the next 25 years, but what Indian customers will demand from it. If the last quarter century is any indication, the answer will surprise us. We have consistently pushed technology beyond its intended boundaries, finding utility, scale and creativity that its creators did not anticipate. The next 25 years will see AI, agentic commerce, and personalisation converge in ways we are only beginning to imagine. But the real transformation will be access: world-class expertise in

healthcare, education and financial decision-making becoming available to anyone, in any language, at any income level. Technology will get more powerful and Indian customers will continue to set the pace. That combination is what makes the next chapter genuinely exciting.

A message to Digit on completing 25 years

What Digit not only got right, but has also managed to sustain for 25 years is understanding that their real reader is never just a tech enthusiast. It is a regular person trying to make a smart decision with their hard-earned money. That orientation toward the consumer, rather than any product or the industry is what has given Digit its credibility and its longevity.

At Amazon, we recognise this focus, because we share it. The best technology partnerships are built on a common belief that informed customers are better customers, for everyone. Digit has held that belief for two and a half decades, through formats, platforms, and technology cycles that would have tested any publication.

Twenty-five years is a significant milestone, one the entire Digit team should be genuinely proud of. Congratulations to the entire team from all of us at Amazon. Here's to the next chapter. **d**

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